

GREGG WILLIAMS

Gregg Williams Tames the Back Nine

A shaky start gave way to five flawless holes that produced the best gross round of the tournament so far.

Gregg Williams began with pars at the 1st and the 2nd. They were the pars of a man with a plan. The plan expired at the 3rd, where he took a triple bogey, and was formally buried at the 4th with a double, on one of Penha Longa's hardest holes. A birdie at the par-3 5th suggested order restored. It did not last. From the 6th to the 8th he went three holes without a net par, including another triple bogey at the 7th, a stretch that cost him four points against par.

Then, without ceremony, he simply stopped making mistakes. From the 11th through the 15th he did not drop a single gross shot. Nine stableford points arrived across the 13th, 14th and 15th alone, gathered with the air of a man collecting something he was owed. It was the best gross round of the day, on his third visit to Penha Longa. It also finished five shots shy of the 82 he carded there in TEG 15, which he may prefer not to dwell on. He stayed top of the TEG 16 Green Jacket standings, his lead swelling from 4 strokes to 14.

AT A GLANCE

ROUND OF THE DAY
Stuart NEUMANN (39 pts)

TROPHY LEAD
Stuart NEUMANN, 12 ahead

GREEN JACKET LEAD
Gregg WILLIAMS, 14 ahead

ROUND STABLEFORD
SN 39 | GW 37 | AB 33 | JB 33 | DM 30
ROUND GROSS
GW +15 | JB +25 | DM +26 | SN +26 | AB +34

AFTER R3 • TROPHY
SN 113 | GW 101 | JB 99 | DM 97 | AB 94
AFTER R3 • GREEN JACKET
GW +55 | JB +69 | DM +71 | SN +82 | AB +110

GREEN JACKET

Jon Baker's Green Jacket Hopes Unravel

A gap of four became a gap of fourteen inside three holes on the back nine.

On the back nine at Penha Longa, with the TEG 16 Green Jacket race live, Jon Baker's round came apart in three holes. A double bogey at the 11th was merely the overture. At the par-5 12th, ranked the easiest hole on the course by stroke index, he took a quintuple bogey 10. The 13th brought a

quadruple bogey 8. Eleven shots gone across the three, and not a single net par among them.

The timing was cruel. Williams had begun the day leading the Jacket race by just 4 shots. He ended it 14 clear, still out front, and much of that was

handed to him rather than won. Baker's return to a course where he had previously gone well came in 12 strokes worse than his last visit to Penha Longa. He did not lose the Jacket race here. He simply stopped competing in it.

WOODEN SPOON

Two Collapses, One Round for Alex Baker

Eleven shots on the front nine, twelve more on the back — the Wooden Spoon gap barely moved because nobody could get close enough to catch him.

Round 3 at Penha Longa offered Alex Baker nothing at all. He arrived already anchored to the bottom of the TEG 16 Wooden Spoon and set about proving the anchor was well placed. He collapsed twice in one round, which shows a certain thoroughness. The first came early. From the 2nd to the 6th he shed 11 shots, including a triple

bogey at the 4th, one of the hardest holes on the course, and four holes running without a net par.

The back nine was worse. Between the 11th and the 14th he bled 12 shots. The centrepiece was a 9 at the 12th, a quadruple bogey on one of the easiest holes out there, and the low point of

another three-hole run without a net par. Nothing on the hole had asked for this.

Baker finished still rooted to the bottom of the Spoon standings. The gap to the next-worst player was unchanged at three points. Two collapses, and not one inch of ground gained or lost. There is a kind of stability in that.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 16, Round 3

COURSE RECORDS

— Alex Baker's 106 at Penha Longa — equals the course-worst, his own mark from TEG 8; 12 earlier rounds there